SHEVA STUDIO · FOCUS PLAYBOOK 01

Start When Your Brain Won't

Five moves that get you from frozen to moving. No willpower required.

> By the end of this 5-minute read, you will have a start routine you can use on your very next task.

Why starting is the hard part

Your brain isn't lazy. It's waiting for the task to feel easy, and it never will. The fix isn't pushing harder. It's making the first move so small your brain can't argue with it.

Use these five moves in order. Stop at any step that gets you going.

STEP 1

The MicroStart

Don't start the task. Start the first ten seconds of the task.

Open the document. Pick up the dish. Put your shoes by the door. That's the whole job.

> **TRY IT NOW**
>
> Pick one task you've been avoiding. Set a timer for 10 seconds. Do only the first move.

STEP 2

The One-Object Rule

Don't clean the room. Clean one object.

If you pick it up, put it away. One thing, finished. Your brain gets a win and the room gets one item better.

> **TRY IT NOW**
>
> Look around. Pick up the nearest thing that's out of place and put it where it lives.

STEP 3

Race the Timer

Set a two-minute timer and try to beat it. Games wake up an ADHD brain in a way deadlines don't.

When it rings, you're allowed to stop. Most days you won't.

> **TRY IT NOW**
>
> Choose a task that feels like ten minutes. Say "I can do two." Start the timer.

STEP 4

The Timebox Ladder

Start with five minutes. If your brain says yes, climb: 5, then 10, then 15.

You never commit to the whole task. You only commit to the next rung.

> **TRY IT NOW**
>
> Write 5, 10, 15 on a sticky note. Do the first rung. Check how you feel before the second.

STEP 5

The Reset Ritual

When your brain stalls, reset your body. It's faster than forcing focus.

Water. Stretch. One big breath. Then go back to Step 1.

> **TRY IT NOW**
>
> Right now: drink some water, roll your shoulders, take one slow breath. Then do a MicroStart.

Your start routine on one page

1	**MicroStart**	Do the first 10 seconds
2	**One-Object Rule**	Pick up one thing, put it away
3	**Race the Timer**	Beat a 2-minute timer
4	**Timebox Ladder**	5 → 10 → 15 minutes
5	**Reset Ritual**	Water, stretch, breathe, restart

What we covered

- You learned five small moves that get you started without willpower.
- You know to stop at whichever step gets you moving.
- **Next action:** pick one task right now and do a 10-second MicroStart.

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>
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Made by Sheva Studio. Share it with someone whose brain works like yours.